

Sony S and a bunch of Android-based ARCHOS tablets for sale – these products haven't yet been launched in India. Pricing is mostly on the higher side as you do have to pay a premium for bagging the latest and the greatest before anyone else. They usually offer 5-10 per cent discounts when you shop using credit cards issued by their affiliated partners (HDFC, ICICI and American Express). Delivery time is approximately 10-12 business days.

Another unique offering at SYW is the ability to shop across multiple popular international online stores with quoted prices in Indian rupees. Clicking on the link to amazon.com from SYW loads



a modified version of the US amazon.com shopping portal, displaying Indian prices for almost the complete list of products available at amazon.com. The prices displayed are higher than the direct conversion from US dollars to rupees, since they include the service charges (mostly profit margins) charged by SYW to provide you with the convenience. Custom duties and shipping charges are both calculated at the final step of making the payment. The advantage in this case is the ability to purchase from big brands like Marks & Spencer, Hugo Boss and other designer stores as long as you can buy them at a premium.

Ordering through shipping companies

The concept of being able to buy imported products without any hassles gives rise to enough opportunities for business and hence, apart from online stores, you have

shipping companies offering the same services via a special account. Aramex, a shipping and logistics service provider offers a "Shop and Ship" account – its e-tail delivery service offers Middle Eastern and Indian consumers the convenience of online shopping from the US, the UK and Europe at competitive rates. Shoppers can access the Aramex service by logging on to ShopandShip.com and signing up for a lifetime membership account which costs \$45 (₹2,230). Once the consumer places an order, Aramex receives the ordered goods at its facilities from the e-tailer, and then ships and delivers them right to the doorstep of the shopper. Here again, the service provider adds customs duties and shipping service charges over and above the final product price that you pay with your credit card.

Unlike eBay Global Easy Buy, this service doesn't have any robust buyer protection mechanism; you have to trust the service provider to get you your stuff. You can choose to pay cash on delivery for all the overheads, thus protecting a part of your total expense. There are similar services from companies like ICC World, in whose case, you have to open a free account, mail the company the products you'd like to purchase from any international site, following which it mails you back with the final quotes for delivering the product to your doorstep. Once you find the quote agreeable, simply purchase the product and use the shipping address provided by them, which is usually their warehousing station from where they manage the delivery mechanism right up to your doorstep.

Choose wisely

The overall deal through the above mentioned options may not necessarily be cheaper. In fact, with mainstream products like phones and cameras from most popular brands, you would most



likely pay more or almost similar to what it would cost you in India. So, how can you take advantage of these services? The trick lies in spotting good deals, and while there's no single formula for spotting deals, here are some general guidelines that can work in your favour.

Accessories are a good starting point. Cases for phones, tablets and similar lower priced products are generally cheaper from these stores. The accessories



market in countries like the US is a lot more matured, you have tonnes of options at every price point and the quality of these products is generally better than what we get in India. We ordered an iPad Case from eBay Global Easy Buy for ₹1,685 shipped to our doorstep. This product carried a retail price of \$75 (₹3,716) in the US. Some of the popular Indian e-tailers were selling the same OtterBox Defender iPad Case for ₹4,500—perfect example of the kind of sweet deals that can be grabbed on Global Easy Buy. With accessories, the usual worries with regard to warranties and damage in transit don't haunt you while placing the order; it's a relatively safe bet, especially when you're not risking huge sums of money.

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